

LG recently launched a rollable TV in India that costs ₹80 lakhs, which we have covered on our social channels. If that's not a frivolous expense, even for a billionaire, we don't know what is. You can probably get better picture quality from LG itself in other products that are a fraction of the price, but of course they won't roll up and



DO NOT BUY AN AIR MULTIPLIER!

disappear at the press of a button. It is a TV though, remember? Its primary job is to display images with the best possible quality. While we have used an exaggerated example on purpose as bait for our social handles, the basic principle is the same. Avoid frivolous purchases, and stick to buying things for their primary purpose and not getting distracted by gimmicks.

If you're looking at a smartphone, you could think about resale value and buy an Apple iPhone as they retain decent value for a longer time than a flagship Android device. Then again, why even pay the premium for the iPhone to begin with, when a cheaper brand Android phone might be all you really need? Similarly, with graphics cards, the prices are now plummeting back to pre-shortage prices thanks to the crypto crash – the investment in the GPU is not worth it any more for miners. However, do you really need a top of the line GPU? Unless you're competing as a professional e-sports gamer, will the drop in resolution or

frame rates in modern games really affect your life? It might be wiser to save up more during the threat of recession, and if it all works out to be nothing much, and you weather the storm well, you can exit the recession gloom with enough money to splurge on a brand new PC instead of just a GPU!

Will a Chromebook do instead of a laptop? Will a 20k phone do the job for the next 2 years, instead of spending 50k and hoping it will run for 3 years? These are the lines along which you should question yourself. Just make sure your purchases will last at least two years, because 2 x 20k phones over 2 years is actually worse than a 30k phone that lasts 2 whole years on its own.

GET A FAMILY PACK

OTT entertainment is such a pain these days. It's the one area where consumers actually would prefer a monopoly of just two or three players. Instead we have an ever-increasing number of services, all with a few good series or movies, all wanting their own subscription. It's time to get creative and start sharing.

Look for family plans which allows multiple people to use the same account with different user profiles, legally. Netflix recently began a crackdown on unauthorized password sharing, but instead of multiple members in a family using different accounts, you could pay a higher sub-

scription tier and get access for more people at once.

Spotify is another example. An individual subscription to Spotify costs ₹119/month. Comparatively, a duo plan, which lets two users use the service, comes in at ₹149/month. Finally, the Family plan, at ₹179/month, allows up to six accounts. If more than one person in your house has a paid Spotify account, you're literally throwing money in the bin by not using the family plan. Per user, the costs work out to ₹119/month in the individual plan, ₹74.5/month in the duo plan, and ₹29.83/month in the family plan.

If you are a student and have an .edu email address, then you should avail of student discounts (if any) for any and ever service that is used in the home or family. Microsoft especially has very cheap pricing for students with their products, such as Office 360 or OneDrive.

Even your mobile network operator is trying to woo you with plans to these services, don't ignore them. If you're a single user in a household, it might actually work out cheaper for you to pay a little more on a mobile subscription to get two or three of these services. While the telecom provider only gives you access to the lowest tier of the OTT service, often you can upgrade these for a small fee that's cheaper than the lower mobile plan and fees for two or three OTT services!

Pick your Premium

Listen without limits on your phone, speaker, and other devices.

One-time plans available

Mini

From ₹77/day
1 account

- ✓ Ad-free music listening on mobile
- ✓ Group Session
- ✓ Download 30 songs on 1 mobile device

VIEW PLANS

Terms and conditions apply.

1 month free

One-time plans available

Individual

₹119/month after offer period
1 account

- ✓ Ad-free music listening
- ✓ Group Session
- ✓ Download 10k songs/device on 5 devices

VIEW PLANS

Terms and conditions apply. 1 month free not available for users who have already used Premium.

1 month free

One-time plans available

Duo

₹149/month after offer period
2 accounts

- ✓ For couples who live together
- ✓ Ad-free music listening
- ✓ Group Session
- ✓ Download 10k songs/device, on 5 devices per account

VIEW PLANS

Terms and conditions apply. 1 month free not available for users who have already used Premium.

1 month free

One-time plans available

Family

₹179/month after offer period
Up to 6 accounts

- ✓ For family who live together
- ✓ Block explicit music
- ✓ Ad-free music listening
- ✓ Group Session
- ✓ Download 10k songs/device on 5 devices

VIEW PLANS

Terms and conditions apply. 1 month free not available for users who have already used Premium.

Source: Spotify

Cheaper. Better.